



Aaron A. Wright

Post-Baccalaureate Research Scientist

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cognitive neuroscience | language & bilingualism | culture & emotion | data visualization

Last updated: July 22nd, 2025

Research Interests

cognitive neuroscience | exploring neural signatures underlying language comprehension and production

language & bilingualism | investigating the impact of linguistic experience on language processing

culture & emotion | examining how cultural and emotional contexts influence language use

data visualization | communicating scientific findings effectively and accessibly

Education

2024

Wenham, MA

B.S. in Cognitive Science of Language; Minors in Psychology, French

Gordon College Honors Institute | Kenneth L. Pike Honors

Advisor(s): Susan Bobb, Ph.D., & Jeffrey Stevenson, Ph.D.

Summa cum laude

Research Experience

† Principal Investigator

2024 - Present

Cambridge, MA

Lisa K. Yang Post-Baccalaureate Research Scholar

Massachusetts Institute of Technology | McGovern Institute for Brain Research, Brain & Cognitive Sciences

EvLab | Advisor(s): Evelina Fedorenko, Ph.D.†, & Agata Wolna, Ph.D.

Neuroimaging and behavioral approaches, investigating the neural bases of language and bilingualism.

2023 - 2024

Framingham, MA

Neuropsychology Research Assistant

Boston University Chobanian & Avedisian School of Medicine | National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute (NHLBI)

Framingham Heart Study Brain Aging Program | Supervisor(s): Julie Joyce, Emma Müller

Psychometric data verification and clinical profile auditing, studying cognitive correlates of neurodegenerative diseases.

2023 - 2024

Wenham, MA

Research Assistant

Gordon College School of Science and Health | Kinesiology

MRI Brass Repository Project | Advisor(s): Peter Iltis, Ph.D.†

Structural neuroimaging and auditory analyses for clinical and behavioral profiling of brass instrumentalists.

Publications

Peer-reviewed

1. Iltis, P. W., Frahm, J., Voit, D., **Wright, A.**, & Dever, A. (2024). A Descriptive Comparison of Oral Cavity Movements Between Brass Instrumentalists Performing Large Interval Slurs. *Medical Problems of Performing Artists*, 39(4), 169-176. [paper]

Preprints

2. Wolna, A., **Wright, A.**, Casto, C., Lipkin, B., & Fedorenko, E. (2025). The extended language network: Language-responsive brain areas whose contributions to language remain to be discovered. *bioRxiv*, 2025-04. [preprint] [osf]

In preparation

3. Poliak, M., Wolna, A., **Wright, A.**, de Varda, A., Gibson, E., & Fedorenko, E. (in prep.). Intrinsic stimulus-related vs. contextual effects in the processing of structured and unstructured language stimuli.
4. Wolna, A., Swords, S., **Wright, A.**, Szewczyk, J. Diaz, M., Domagalik, A., Szwed, M., Wodniecka, Z., & Fedorenko, E. (in prep.). Broca is alive and well: an articulation-selective area in the left inferior frontal gyrus, distinct from nearby language and Multiple Demand areas.
5. Wolna, A., **Wright, A.**, Wodniecka, Z., Fedorenko, E. (in prep.). From words to stories: Engagement of language-specific and domain-general neural mechanisms in native and second language.

Posters & Presentations

* Presenting author(s) | reverse chron.

1. Wolna, A. **Wright, A.***, Casto, C., Lipkin, B., & Fedorenko, E. (2025, April). *The extended language network: Language selective brain areas whose contributions to language remain to be discovered*. [Poster Presentation]. **Patrick J. McGovern Travel & Technology Awards Poster Session**, Cambridge, MA.
2. Wolna, A.*, **Wright, A.***, Wodniecka, Z., Fedorenko, E. (2025, March). *From words to stories: Engagement of language-specific and domain-general neural mechanisms in native and second language comprehension* [Poster Presentation]. **Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Neuroscience Society**, Boston, MA.
3. Iltis, P. W., Frahm, J., Voit, D., **Wright, A. A.***, & Dever, A. R*. (2024, February). *A descriptive comparison of oral cavity movements between brass instrumentalists performing large interval slurs*. [Symposium] **North Shore Sigma Xi Research Symposium**, Wenham, MA.
4. **Wright, A. A.***, Cho, Y.*, Dominguez, M. V.*, & Williams, A. L.* (2022, April). *Influence of interactive social dynamic roles on the use of accommodative speech*. [Symposium]. **Gordon College Undergraduate Research Symposium**, Wenham, MA.
5. **Wright, A. A.***, Niles, R. K.*, & Lee, S.* (2022, April). *EEG synchrony during mental attention tasks reflects differences in cognitive processing*. [Symposium]. **Gordon College Undergraduate Research Symposium**, Wenham, MA.
6. **Wright, A. A.***, Niles, R. K.*, Dambo, L. K.*, & Szumierz, C. S.* (2021, May). *The effects of concussions on the working memory in young adult athletes*. [Symposium]. **Gordon College Undergraduate Research Symposium**, Wenham, MA.

Awards & Honors

† Competitive funding | * merit-based

2025	School of Science Quality of Life Grant [†] Massachusetts Institute of Technology
2024	BCS Spot Appreciation Award * Massachusetts Institute of Technology
2023	Dick and Judy Gross Servant Leadership Scholarship ^{†*} Gordon College
2023	Marion Jackson Carter Endowment Award ^{†*} Gordon College
2020 - 2024	Presidential Honors * Gordon College

Memberships & Affiliations

2025 - Present **Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS)**
 2021 - Present **Psi Chi International Honor Society in Psychology**

Activities & Service

Academic investment & mentorship

2022 - 2024 **Chapter President** | Psi Chi International Honors Society in Psychology
Gordon College School of Psychology and Human Services | Psychology
 2022 **Club President** | Neuroscience Club
Gordon College School of Psychology and Human Services & School of Science and Health | Psychology, Neuroscience
 2021 - 2022 **Teacher's Assistant** | Research Methods I (PSY156)
Gordon College School of Psychology and Human Services | Psychology
 2021 **Teacher's Assistant** | Introduction to Linguistics (LIN201)
Gordon College School of Humanities and Social Sciences | Linguistics

Scientific outreach & international experience

2025 **MGH Aspire Summer 2025 Adventure Camp Trailblazers**
Massachusetts Institute of Technology | McGovern Institute for Brain Research
 Tour of the McGovern Institute for Mass General Brigham's Aspire program for young teens identifying with ASD.
 2025 **Workshop, "Building a Personal Research Website"**
Massachusetts Institute of Technology | McGovern Institute for Brain Research, Picower Institute for Learning and Memory
 Created and led three-part workshop series on designing a personal research website with GitHub Pages.
 2023 **Engage Lead: Cambodia**
Phnom Penh, Cambodia
 Assisted with teaching at Khmer universities, hosted IELTS prep workshops; participated in cross-cultural leadership training.
 2023 **Compass Path: Iceland**
Reykjavík, Iceland
 Relational, volunteer service for immigrant and refugee communities; organized extracurricular programming for local youth.

Languages

English speaking: native | reading: native | writing: native
 French speaking: intermediate | reading: intermediate | writing: intermediate

Experimental Methodology & Skills

Neuroimaging & analysis (fMRI)	CONN Toolbox Connectome Workbench FreeSurfer FSL SPM
Programming languages & platforms	MATLAB Python (Visual Studio Code) R (RStudio)
Reproducible science & data	Positron Git / GitHub Quarto
Behavioral experimentation	Audacity Praat Prolific
Data visualization	Adobe Illustrator

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Well, that is one of the things to find out sometime. Isn't it splendid to think of all the things there are to find out about? It just makes me feel glad to be alive — it's such an interesting world. It wouldn't be half so interesting if we know all about everything, would it?

— *Anne of Green Gables, L. M. Montgomery*